GRADE 10 / English HL / English

Read closely and quote with purpose

01 Understand

Learning goals: Identify literal information • Infer meaning from evidence • Explain a word choice in context

Literal questions ask for information stated directly. Inference combines a textual clue with a reasonable explanation; it is not unsupported guessing.

A quotation supports a point only when you explain how its wording matters. Keep quotations short and relevant.

Tone is the speaker’s attitude. Use the language of the passage to justify your description rather than choosing a tone word from memory.

From clue to explanation

Textual clue	Possible inference	Reasoning
checked the empty road	expectation or worry	repeated attention to an arrival
finally exhaled	relief	tension has eased
warm light	comfort	positive sensory association

02 Follow the reasoning

Original text: “Lindi checked the empty road again. When the bus appeared, she finally exhaled and stepped into its warm light.” Explain Lindi’s likely feelings.

1. The word “again” suggests repeated checking, supporting an inference of anxious waiting.

2. “Finally exhaled” suggests relief when the bus arrives.

3. “Warm light” gives the ending a comforting mood. The text does not establish why she was waiting or where she is going.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. What appears on the road?

2. Explain the effect of “again”.

3. Does the text prove that the bus was late? Justify.

04 Check and correct

1. A bus.

2. It suggests repeated action and can emphasise anticipation or worry.

3. No. It shows waiting but gives no timetable or expected arrival time.

Common mistake to avoid

Do not invent a backstory. An inference must be supported by the words actually provided.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Reading and viewing: comprehension; language in context

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: English. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID enhl-10.